RETAIL SALES ESSENTIALS

Retail Sales Essentials — Day 4: The Retail Floor: Approaching Walk-Ins and Add-On Selling

Study guide · Self-study

Day 4: The Retail Floor: Approaching Walk-Ins and Add-On Selling

How to Use This Guide

Today you learn the two skills that fill most of a shift in a store: walking up to someone who has just come in, and suggesting one more item without making them back away. Read each section, do the short reflection where it appears, then answer the quiz before you look at the model answers. Write your own answers first, in your own words. The model answers at the end are examples, not scripts — what matters is the principle behind each one.

Keep a small notebook with you this week. You will use it for the observation work in this guide. If you are not working in a store yet, every task here has a second way to do it: watch customers in any shop you visit, or take the roles of customer and seller with a friend and record yourself on your phone. You learn the same skills either way.

Today's Objectives (KASU)

Knowledge: You will know the A.I.M. offer structure (Anchor, Illuminate, Mobilize) and why customers give or refuse add-on suggestions.

Attitude: You will treat a walk-in's first seconds as their decision to make, not yours to force.

Skill: You will be able to read openness signals, time your approach, and make one add-on suggestion using A.I.M.

Upskill: You will be able to recover a customer who steps back or says "just looking" without pressure, and still earn a second conversation.

Reading the Walk-In: Openness and Timing

A customer who walks in is not yet a customer. They are a person deciding whether this store is worth their time. In the first seconds, they are using fast, automatic thinking — the System 1 mode you met on Day 1. They scan the space, judge whether they will be pressured, and decide whether to settle in or drift back out. Your approach either feeds that fast judgment or interrupts it.

Openness shows in the body before it shows in words. Watch for these signals:

- ☐ Feet turn toward the product, not the door
- ☐ Hands come out of pockets and reach for items
- ☐ Eyes slow down on one display instead of sweeping the room
- ☐ Shoulders drop, pace slows
- ☐ They take the earbuds out or look up as you pass

Closed signals look different: feet still pointed at the exit, a fast walk-through, arms crossed with a phone in hand, a glance at the door every few steps. None of these is a no. They are information about pace. A customer with closed signals still needs time to settle; approaching right now usually speeds their exit.

Timing is the skill. Walk up too early and you interrupt their first look, which feels like being managed. Too late and they have already made up their mind alone or walked out. A practical guide:

let them take a few steps in and make first contact with a display. That is the moment they have chosen something to look at — and a low-threat opening is easier once they have. The First-Contact Standard (MEDJAY adaptation, based on Kahneman, Brehm and Guyer et al.) you learned on Day 2 still applies here: low threat, autonomy, relevance, curiosity. Today you add the timing decision before it.

Here is what the customer is feeling in those seconds. They have been greeted by sellers many times. They expect a pitch. When you open calmly, give them room to decline, and ask about what they are already looking at, that expectation breaks. The relief is what makes them stay.

If you want to practice this without a store of your own, sit in any shop for a few minutes and watch feet and hands as people enter. You will spot the difference between settling in and passing through within one visit.

The A.I.M. Offer Structure

A.I.M. is MEDJAY's own framework for structuring an offer, developed by Steven Saad. It has exactly 3 steps, used in order.

A — Anchor: Name the customer's specific pain or gap in their own words. Not your words. Theirs. "You said the case has to survive the school run." The Anchor proves you listened and pins the conversation to something real. It also settles a small question in the customer's mind: does this person see my situation or just my wallet?

I — Illuminate: Show the one thing that removes that pain, with proof the customer can check. One thing, not five. A demonstration, a label, a warranty card, a short comparison — something they can hold or read. Fast thinking trusts what it can verify directly, so the proof does the persuading, not your adjectives.

M — Mobilize: Ask for one small, easy, useful next step. "Which of these two would you like to try?" or "Take it to the door and see if it fits in your bag." The next step is small enough to say yes to without risk. That is why it works: the customer does not have to decide on the whole purchase yet. A small step also builds commitment — once someone has acted, they are more likely to continue.

A.I.M. is for offers and presentations, including add-ons. It is not for objections. When a customer pushes back, A.R.T. from Day 3 still applies — Acknowledge, Reframe, Transition — and you will use it exactly as you learned it.

Why the structure matters: a customer's attention is short and their guard is up. An unstructured pitch gives them ten things to judge at once. Anchoring first makes one thing matter; illuminating shows proof; mobilizing makes the decision small. Each step lowers the effort of saying yes.

Watch out: the Anchor must come from the customer. An Anchor you invent — "most people need this" — is a pitch in disguise, and customers hear it.

Add-On Selling That Feels Helpful

An add-on is not an upsell by another name. It is a second item that makes the first one work better for this specific customer. The test is simple: would you recommend it if you earned nothing from it? If the answer is no, it is not an add-on.

Customers buy add-ons for reasons that have little to do with the extra item itself. They buy because the recommendation:

- closes a friction they already noticed ("I'll forget the charger on trips")
- protects a purchase they now feel is theirs (the endowment effect, which you met on Day 1: once people own something, they value it more and want it to work)
- reduces regret before it happens ("I don't want to come back next week")
- comes with a visible reason, not a sales line
- Timing decides most of it. The best moment for an add-on is not the moment they pick up the main item — it is the moment they have decided. They have relaxed, they are talking about where they will use it, they have stopped comparing. An add-on then feels like part of buying the thing, not a new sales pitch. Presenting it earlier competes with their decision and gets refused.
- Use A.I.M. for the add-on too. Anchor: their own situation. Illuminate: the one thing and a checkable proof. Mobilize: a small next step, or a genuine choice: "Do you want the smaller pack or the larger one for the trip?"
- Genuine scarcity is allowed — when it is real. If a size is actually down to the last one on the shelf, you may say so, plainly, once. If a promotion genuinely ends this week, you may name the date. Never invent stock or a deadline. Customers remember false urgency long after they forget the product.
- When a customer asks for a discount on the main item or on the add-on, do not simply drop the price. Ask for something of equal value in return — a second item at full price, a slightly larger pack, a decision today. This is the rule trade, don't concede. A discount given freely teaches the customer that prices here are negotiable, and the next request comes faster.
- Practice example: A customer is buying a rain jacket. You say: "You mentioned the commute is mostly by bike. The jacket's outside pockets are not sealed, and in heavy rain the phone in your pocket gets wet. This chest pocket is sealed — here, put your hand in. Do you want me to check if we have the matching waterproof phone pouch in the same size?"

Apply It in Your Role

This week is a sequence of walk-ins, and every one of them is practice. Here is how to use this guide. If you are not on a store floor yet, use the alternative in each step — it teaches exactly the same thing.

First, take one shift — or one visit to any shop — and count open and closed walk-ins. Not to judge yourself, just to learn your eye. Note in your notebook how many people looked at a display within a few steps, and how many walked straight past. Over one shift you will start to sense timing instead of calculating it.

Second, use A.I.M. while you shadow. Before your supervisor or an experienced colleague goes to a customer, whisper your Anchor guess: "I'll bet the pain is the size." Afterward, compare. Do this with a real customer only when someone senior is beside you, and let them lead. If you have no colleague to shadow, watch a seller in any shop from a distance and guess their Anchor, then check it against what the customer says.

Third, make one add-on suggestion per shift using A.I.M. on purpose. One, not five. Afterward, write one line: what the Anchor was, and whether the customer accepted the next step. You are building your own pattern bank. No shop yet? Set up a role-play with a friend: they play the customer, you make the suggestion, and you record it to review later.

Notice what the customer does, not just what they say. A quiet "maybe" with a step toward the shelf is a yes forming. A cheerful "sure" with a step back is not. Your eyes on their feet will teach you more than any script.

Reflection: Think of a time you were shopping and someone approached you at the right moment. What did they do or say that made you stay? Write three lines. Where did they Anchor, and was the next step small? If you cannot remember one, write about an approach that made you want to leave — that teaches the timing rule just as well.

What Would You Say?

Write your answer to each situation before reading the model answers. Keep it short, one or two sentences per situation. If you are not yet serving customers, answer as if you were, or play the scene through with a friend.

1. A customer walks in, looks at a display of bags for a few seconds, and picks one up. Write your low-threat opening plus the first question you would ask.

2. A customer is trying on a jacket and says, "I mostly travel for work, so it needs to pack small." Write an add-on suggestion using A.I.M. in 3 steps.

3. A customer says, "Just looking," and keeps walking. Write what you say next.

4. A customer has chosen a suitcase and is heading to the counter. Name one add-on you would realistically suggest in a store you know, and write the Mobilize step.

5. A customer asks for a discount on the item you are about to add. Write the line that asks for something of equal value in return.

Key Takeaways

Walk-ins decide with fast, automatic thinking whether to stay. Read their body and time your approach instead of greeting everything that moves.

A.I.M. — MEDJAY's own offer framework (Anchor, Illuminate, Mobilize) — has exactly 3 steps. Anchor in the customer's words, illuminate with one checkable thing, mobilize with one small step.

An add-on is a second item that makes the first work better. If you would not recommend it for free, do not recommend it.

Suggest add-ons after the customer has decided, not during. That is when it lands as help, not pressure.

Use real scarcity, never invented urgency. Ask for something in return before you give a discount.

Watch out: the biggest rookie mistake on Day 4 is stacking add-ons on a customer who has not finished deciding the first item.

Quiz

Answer each question, then check the notes below. The quiz is worth 100 points in total and you pass at 70.

1. (20 points) Which set of signals most clearly suggests a walk-in is open to an approach?
   A. Hands out of pockets, eyes slowing on a display, shoulders relaxed
   B. Feet pointed at the door, arms crossed, fast pace
   C. Phone in hand, walking straight toward the back of the store
   D. Scanning the room quickly and turning around

2. (20 points) What is the correct order of the A.I.M. steps?
   A. Illuminate, Anchor, Mobilize
   B. Anchor, Illuminate, Mobilize
   C. Mobilize, Anchor, Illuminate
   D. Anchor, Mobilize, Illuminate

3. (20 points) When is an add-on suggestion most likely to be accepted?
   A. As soon as the customer picks up the main item
   B. Before the customer has said anything
   C. After the customer has decided and mentions where they will use the item
   D. When it is offered with a discount

4. (20 points) A customer says, "Just looking." Which response fits the approach taught today?
   A. "Everyone says that — what you really want is over here."
   B. "No problem. I'll be right here by the bags if anything catches your eye."
   C. "Would you like to sign up for our loyalty card?"
   D. "Shall I show you our bestseller right now?"

5. (20 points) Where does today's training say A.R.T. belongs?
   A. For presenting an add-on
   B. For opening a conversation with a walk-in
   C. For offering a discount
   D. For objections and concerns, exactly as learned on Day 3

Upskill Challenge

This week, run the following, with support from a colleague or your supervisor where needed, or by observing any shop and role-playing with a friend if you are not in a store yet. Write each step in your notebook.

- ☐ Observe one full shift — or one visit to any shop — and count open and closed walk-ins. Note what convinced you each one was open or closed.

☐ Before three shadowed walk-ins — or three watched from a distance in any shop — guess the customer's Anchor out loud to your colleague or to yourself. Compare your guess with what the customer actually said.

☐ Make one add-on suggestion per shift using A.I.M., three shifts in a row. No shift yet? Role-play three scenes with a friend and record them. Write the Anchor, the proof you showed, and the next step you asked for.

☐ Recover one "just looking" moment using low threat and autonomy. Note what the customer did next.

☐ Keep a tally for the week:

Number of walk-ins observed: ____

Number of add-on suggestions made: ____

Number of add-ons accepted: ____

Conversion rate (accepted ÷ suggestions): ____

Total: ____

Practice example: If you suggested add-ons 6 times and 2 were accepted, your rate for that week is 2 ÷ 6, about 33 percent. These are your early numbers, not a benchmark. After a few weeks, compare one week with the next.

Model Answers

These are examples. Say them in your own words so they sound like you.

1. Open calmly and give a reason this contact is about them: "Hi, I'm (your name) — I'll leave you to look. Those bags are new in this week; are you after something for every day, or something for a trip?" Why it works: it is low threat, gives them room, and one open question about the bags invites them to talk.

2. Anchor: "You said it has to pack small for work travel." Illuminate: "This one folds into its own pocket — watch. It goes flat in a laptop bag." Mobilize: "What would make folding it easiest for you to try — shall I walk you through it, or do you want to fold it yourself?" Why it works: the Anchor is the customer's own situation, the proof is checkable in their hands, and the step is small with a real choice in it.

3. "Of course. I'll be right here by the bags if you want a hand. What are you shopping for today?" Why it works: it accepts their words without correcting them, stays low threat, and offers a gentle opening without a demand.

4. For a suitcase: "You said you fly every month and have been caught at the gate. This travel scale is the one thing that stops that. It weighs to a small fraction — put your packed case on it now. Do you want the small one or the one that stays in the case?" Why it works: it anchors in their story and offers a genuine choice of next step with no risk.

5. "I can look at the price on the set if you take both items today. Would that work, or would the second one at full price suit you better?" Why it works: it is trade, don't concede — something of equal value in return, not a free discount.

- Quiz answers:
- 1. A. The open body — hands out, eyes slowing, shoulders relaxed — shows the customer has chosen something to look at, which is the moment to approach. (20 points)
- 2. B. A.I.M. is Anchor, then Illuminate, then Mobilize, used in that order, exactly 3 steps. (20 points)
- 3. C. An add-on lands once the main decision is made, when it works as help rather than competition. (20 points)
- 4. B. The reply lowers threat, keeps the customer's autonomy, and names something relevant — the bags — without forcing a next step. (20 points)
- 5. D. A.R.T. is used only for handling objections and concerns, exactly as learned on Day 3. (20 points)
- Total: 100 points. Pass mark: 70.

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